

June 20, 2024

Dear Dr. Casadevall,

I am pleased to submit the manuscript, "Artificial intelligence" to mBio as a Perspective-formatted article. As I am sure you are aware, generative artificial intelligence has rapidly grown in popularity over the past few years. Scientists are particularly eager to use these methods. Distressing to me is the lack of serious, contrary points of view. My manuscript pushes back at the proponents of artificial intelligence. My concerns are that artificial intelligence dehumanizes scientists and further commoditizes science. Further, it stands to erase core benefits of developing a diverse scientific workforce. As an educator who is concerned about the education of society and training the next generation of scientists, I believe that artificial intelligence short circuits the learning process. It will have significant impacts on the development of critical thinking skills. We need to resist the adoption of generative artificial intelligence in microbiology.

I recognize that I may currently have a minority view on artificial intelligence; however, such view points are necessary for a full and open dialog. This manuscript is submitted independently of my service as the Chair of the ASM Journals Committee. Finally, generative artificial intelligence tools were not knowingly used to prepare this manuscript.

Sincerely,



Patrick D. Schloss